Project: *Wisconsin Bones: Gems of Pandora*

Engine: Unreal Engine 5

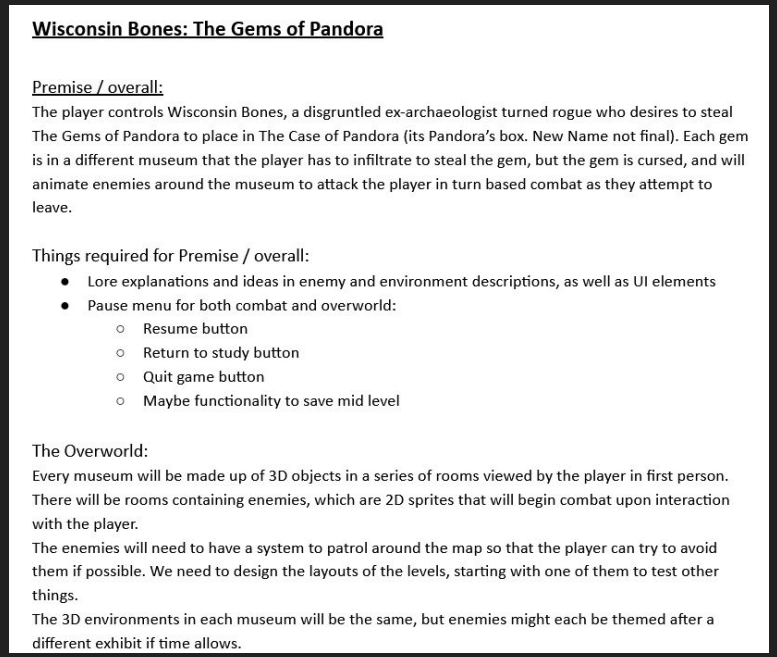
Platform: PC

Genre: Dungeon-Crawler RPG

Summary: This game was made for the month-long Bad Ideas Game Jam 2026. The theme was “outside the box”, so we took inspiration from the myth of Pandora’s box and the idea of adventurers opening things they shouldn’t. The end result was a short dungeon-crawler with turn-based RPG combat.

Game Design: Working with the team's dedicated game designer, I helped to design the game's core loop and the turn-based combat system, including its counter mechanic and the gem powers.

Programming: Using Unreal Blueprints, I was tasked with scripting the entire turn-based battle scene, including character stats, ability logic, turn order management, and damage calculation. I also designed the UI graphics.



Wisconsin Bones: The Gems of Pandora

Premise / overall:

The player controls Wisconsin Bones, a disgruntled ex-archaeologist turned rogue who desires to steal The Gems of Pandora to place in The Case of Pandora (its Pandora's box. New Name not final). Each gem is in a different museum that the player has to infiltrate to steal the gem, but the gem is cursed, and will animate enemies around the museum to attack the player in turn based combat as they attempt to leave.

Things required for Premise / overall:

- Lore explanations and ideas in enemy and environment descriptions, as well as UI elements
- Pause menu for both combat and overworld:
  - Resume button
  - Return to study button
  - Quit game button
  - Maybe functionality to save mid level

The Overworld:

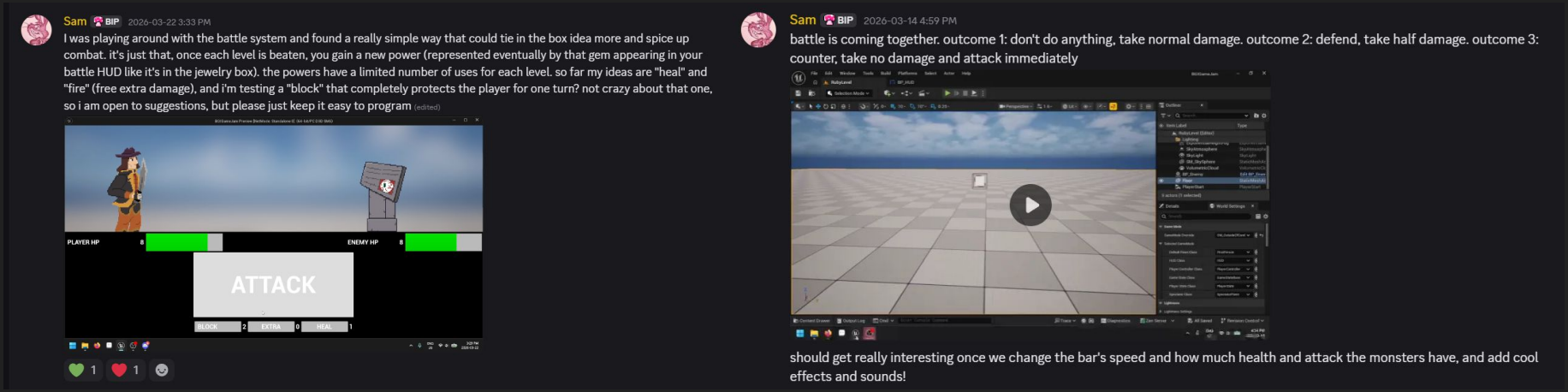
Every museum will be made up of 3D objects in a series of rooms viewed by the player in first person. There will be rooms containing enemies, which are 2D sprites that will begin combat upon interaction with the player.

The enemies will need to have a system to patrol around the map so that the player can try to avoid them if possible. We need to design the layouts of the levels, starting with one of them to test other things.

The 3D environments in each museum will be the same, but enemies might each be themed after a different exhibit if time allows.

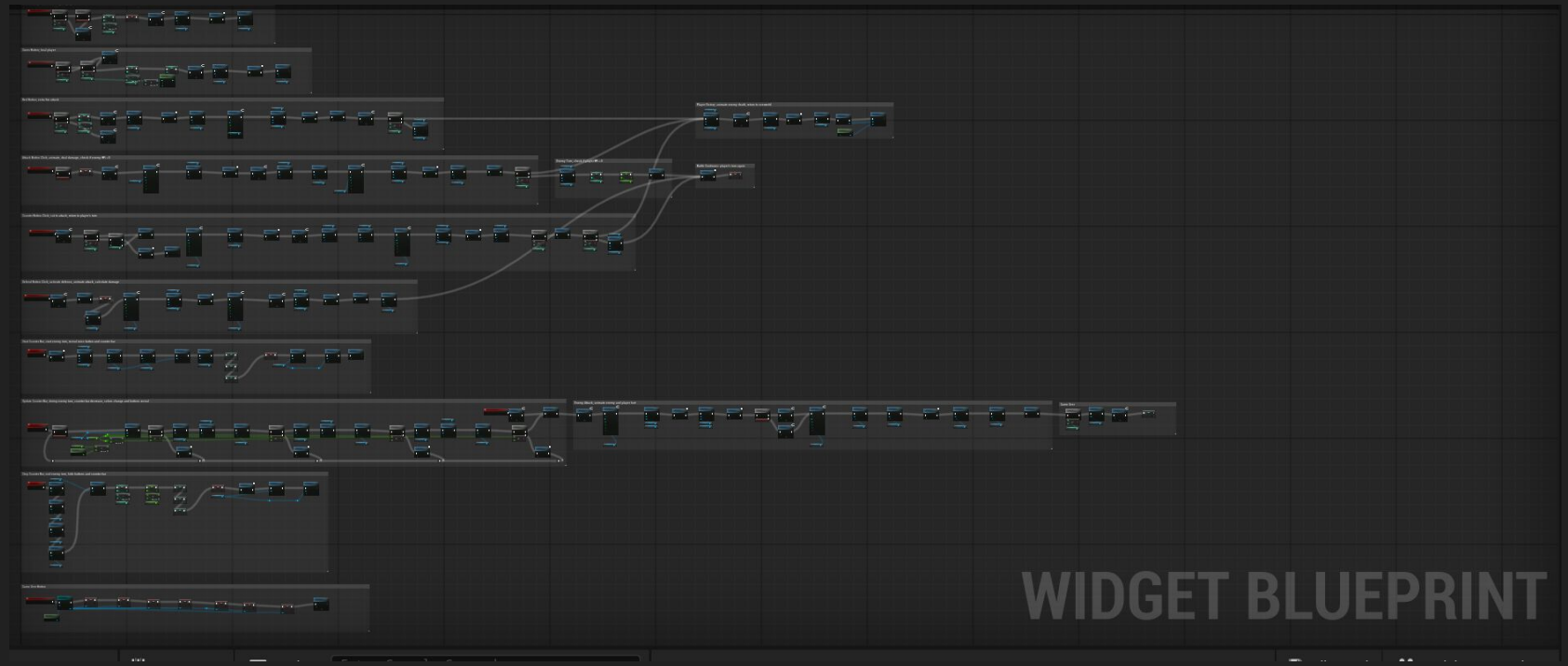
First page of the game design document.

Documentation (programming)



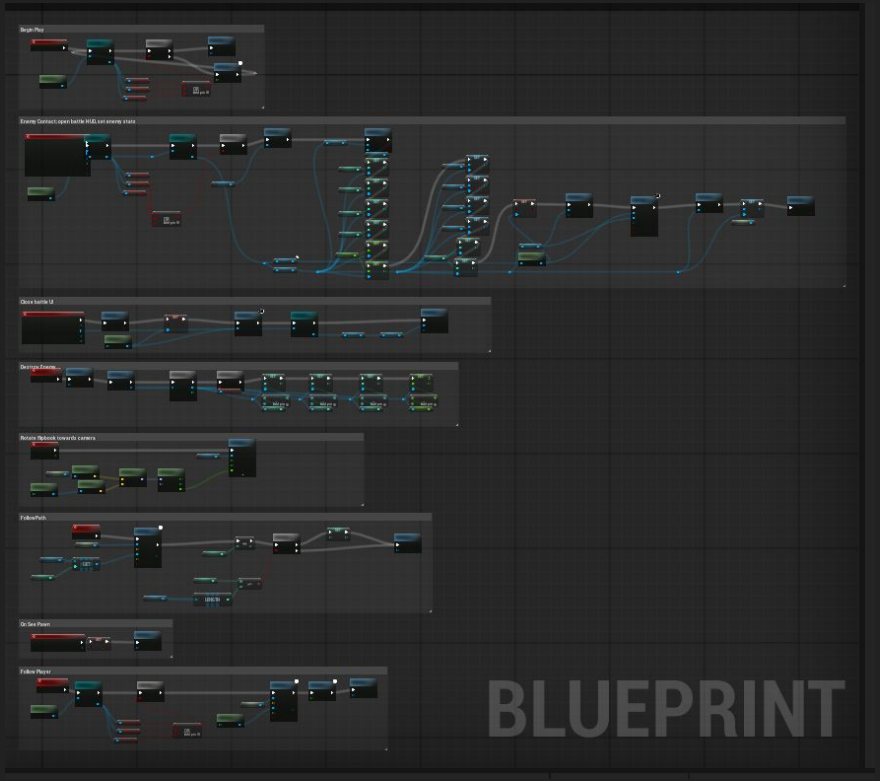
To maintain team alignment and gather actionable feedback throughout the jam, I consistently sent video progress updates to our group's Discord channel, keeping everyone informed and engaged from start to finish.

Blueprints (programming)



The main combat Blueprint quickly grew into the largest system I made for the project. I made sure to keep it organized and well-documented, categorizing nodes with descriptive comments so that the entire team could easily parse and work within the combat framework without friction.

Blueprints (programming)



The enemy Blueprint, which was also pretty big, but I kept it organized.